H-B-00531d(GSA-FSS)
October 7, 1966
INTERIM REVISION OF
Fed. Spec. H-B-531c
November 16, 1962

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BRUSH, SCRUB, DECK

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification H-B-531c, dated November 16, 1962.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers two types and one grade of deck scrubbing brushes.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Grade and types. Deck scrubbing brushes covered by this specification shall be of the following types, as specified in the invitation for bids (see 6.2).

Types:

I - Without handle
II - With handle

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

NN-H-104 - Handles, Wood, Acme Threaded and Circular Tapered End.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

FSC 7920

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(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-W-6110 - Wood, Determination of Moisture content of

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample. When specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced, a sample brush covered by this specification shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for approval in accordance with 4.2. The approval of the preproduction sample authorizes the commencement of production, but does not relieve the supplier of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The preproduction sample shall be manufactured in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production item.

3.2 Standard product. The brushes delivered under this specification shall be the manufacturer's standard commercial product except for any design modification and additional requirements specified herein.

3.3 Materials. Materials shall conform to the requirements specified hereinafter. Materials not definitely specified shall be of the quality used for the purpose in commercial practice.

3.3.1 Fiber. The fiber shall be 100 percent natural palmyra.

3.3.2 Wood (block). The blocks shall be hardwood, thoroughly seasoned, dense, close grained species such as beech, birch, maple, ash, or oak. The wood shall be thoroughly and uniformly dried to a moisture content of not less than 8 and not more than 12 percent when tested as specified in 4.4.3 (see 4.3.2.1).

3.3.3 Staple wire. The staple wire shall be commercial steel staple wire, plated or coated to resist corrosion, or a commercial grade of corrosion-resisting wire. The diameter shall be not less than 0.0455 inch.

3.4 Construction. The construction of the brushes shall conform to the requirements specified herein and in table I and shall be similar to figure 1. Type I brushes shall be furnished without handles; type II brushes shall have handles conforming to 3.4.2. Figure 1, incorporated in this specification, is included for identification only and is not intended to preclude the purchase of brushes otherwise in accordance with the requirements of this specification.

3.4.1 Block. The block shall be one piece construction, and manufactured from the wood specified in 3.3.2. The block shall be smoothly sanded. The manufacturer shall have the option of

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coating both ends by using a suitable wax process; or either coating the ends or the entire block with varnish, lacquer, or other suitable transparent organic finish. The side edges of the block top shall either have a chamfer or a radius in accordance with standard commercial practice. The block shall be provided with two tapered handle holes both equidistant from the ends of the block. The holes for the handle shall be bored through the block at an angle so that in use the brush may be used with facility and effectiveness. The holes for the handle shall be tapered in the same ratio as the block end of the handle (3.4.2) and shall fit the handle closely. The holes for the fiber shall be located in such a manner so as to provide a full bristle face that covers a working area as large as the block size permits. Note: Bristle density in the area of the handle holes shall not be less than that consistent with best commercial practice.

3.4.2 Wood handle. When type II brushes are specified the handle shall conform to type II, size 3 (1-1/8 in. dia.), with a length of 4-1/2 feet as specified in NN-H-104.

3.4.3 Fiber (bristles).

3.4.3.1 Set. The fiber shall solidly fill the tuft holes in the block and shall be securely staple set with wire staples (3.3.3). The staples shall straddle over the middle of the tuft and shall be driven into the block at the bottom of the tuft holes so the tuft shall not separate from the block when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

3.4.3.2 Weight. The weight of the fiber shall be as indicated in table I when tested as specified in 4.4.2.

Table I. Physical requirements

Block:	
Length, minimum inches	9-3/4
Width, minimum inches	2-3/4
Thickness, minimum inches	1-1/4
Holes for fiber:	
Depth, approximately, inch	3/8
Number of holes, in accordance with manufacturer's standard commercial practice.	—
Fiber:	
Weight, minimum ounces	5.2
Length, clear of block, minimum inches	2
Handle:	
Length, inches	54 ± 1/2
Diameter, except at taper end, inches	1-1/8 ± 1/32
Note: Handle shall meet requirements specified for type II, size 3 of NN-H-104.	

3.5 Marking for identification. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2) in addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, the manufacturer shall permanently and legibly indent his name, or trademark of such known character easily identifiable with said manufacturer, on each brush block.

3.6 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be in accordance with the best commercial practice. The brush block assembles shall be free from defects which affect their appearance, durability, and serviceability. Handles, when furnished, shall be of the quality required by NN-H-104.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial

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laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preproduction sample inspection. When a preproduction sample is required, it shall be examined for the defects in table II and specified dimensions. The preproduction sample shall be tested in accordance with 4.4.1 and 4.4.2.

4.3 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sample for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.3.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.3.2 In process inspection.

4.3.2.1 Moisture content of block. The brush block shall be tested (see 4.4.3) for moisture content prior to machining in accordance with MIL-W-6110 to determine compliance with 3.3.2. The sample unit shall be one block. The lot shall be the number of blocks offered for inspection at one time. Three determinations shall be taken on each sample unit and the results shall be the average of three determinations. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 2.0 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.3.3 End item inspection. The lot shall consist of all brushes and handles, when specified, offered for inspection at one time. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated brush and handle, if specified.

4.3.3.1 Visual examination. Examination shall be made of the end item for the defects in table II. The inspection level shall be level II with an AQL of 4.0 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

Table II. Visual defects

Examine	Defects
Finish	Block not smoothly sanded. Block or ends not coated with wax, varnish, lacquer, or other suitable transparent organic finish. Coating not uniform or continuous; wet or tacky; dirt or foreign matter imbedded. Handles (when specified) not finished in accordance with NN-H-104.
Construction or Workmanship	Block not seasoned, dense, close grained hardwood; any knot hole or loose knot; any tight or firmly encased knot 3/16 inch or more in diameter; any season check, fracture, or split; any worm hole, larva channel or pocket; any wane (lack of wood); loose, raised, or torn grain producing a rough surface. Handle does not fit tapered holes closely. Staples protrude into handle holes. Fiber embedded with foreign matter, dirty, or not properly trimmed. Fiber too dry and brittle. Bristle face not full and covering block area. Large void in bristle face over handle hole openings. Handle, when furnished, not free of defects specified in NN-H-104.
Markings for identification	Omitted, illegible. Special markings not provided when specified.

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4.3.3.2 Dimensional examination. Inspection shall be made of the end item for compliance with table I. Any deviation from specified requirements shall constitute a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 expressed in the terms of defects per hundred units.

4.3.3.3 Testing of the end item. The end item shall be tested as specified in 4.4.1 and 4.4.2. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 expressed in the terms of defects per hundred units.

4.3.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table III. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Table III. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping or distortion of container.
Contents (exterior and interior container)	Number per container is more or less than required.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Retention of fiber. Grasp the individual tuft of fibers with a suitable holding device and apply a pulling force, with a spring scale or a weight, of eight pounds in a direction tending to pull the tuft from the block to determine compliance with 3.4.3.1. Ten determinations shall be made per brush. Failure of one or more determinations shall constitute a defect.

4.4.2 Weight of fiber. The fiber shall be removed from the block and shall be conditioned for not less than 16 hours in air at a relative humidity of 50 plus or minus 4 percent and at a temperature of 23° plus or minus 1.1°C (73.5 ± 2°F). The weight of the fiber shall be determined in the same atmosphere to determine compliance with table I (see 3.4.3.2).

4.4.3 Test for moisture content of block. Wood for the block shall be tested for moisture content in accordance with any method specified in MIL-W-6110 to determine compliance with 3.3.2.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 Brushes. Packaging for brushes shall not be required.

5.1.2 Handles. Packaging for handles shall not be required (see 5.2.2.2).

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A or B as specified:

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Brushes. Twenty-four brushes shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box conforming to class weather-resistant, V3c or V3s of PPP-B-636. Arrangement of the brushes shall be

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2 in length, 4 in width and 3 deep. The box shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the appendix of the applicable box specification. In lieu of strapping, pressure-sensitive filament tape may be used and applied in accordance with the appendix.

5.2.1.2 Handles. Twelve handles shall be bundled and secured with filament reinforced tape or steel strapping or round wire. Two bundles shall be completely wrapped in jute (or kenaf) burlap cloth or bottom with osnaburg with ends folded. The complete wrapping shall be secured by sewing ends and side seams with strong yarn or twine.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Brushes. Twenty-four units of one unit each shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box conforming to class domestic, type CF or type SF of PPP-B-636. Bursting strength of fiberboard used in the box construction shall be not less than 200 pounds per square inch. Closure shall be in accordance with PPP-B-636. (Appendix).

5.2.2.2 Handles. Twenty-four handles shall be formed with a compact bundle with all ends even, then completely wrapped in burlap, osnaburg, or similar material (cloth), ends folded and the complete wrapping secured by stitching ends and side seams with strong cotton twine. Alternatively, the 24 handles may be bundled, then completely wrapped with at least two thicknesses of 50/60 pound kraft paper. Ends shall be neatly folded and wrap shall be secured with a suitable adhesive.

5.2.3 Standard Pack (civil agency procurements). The standard pack for brushes and handles shall be as specified (see 5.2.2.1 and 5.2.2.2).

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers and bundles shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-219.

6. NOTES.

6.1 Intended use. The brushes covered by this specification are intended for scrubbing decks of seagoing ships, floors, walls, rugs, tables, benches, etc., where a long-handle scrubbing brush is suitable.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired option offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type of brush required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Whether preproduction sample is required (see 3.1).
(d) Special markings required (see 3.5).
(e) Selection of applicable level of packing required (see 5.2).

6.3 The estimated shelf life of these brushes is approximately six months. Therefore, it is recommended that not more than a six month's supply be kept on hand, and care be taken to issue all the old stock before commencing to issue the new. Suitable storage space should be provided in a well-ventilated building as it is essential that these brushes be allowed to absorb moisture freely from the atmosphere to prevent the fiber from drying out and becoming brittle.

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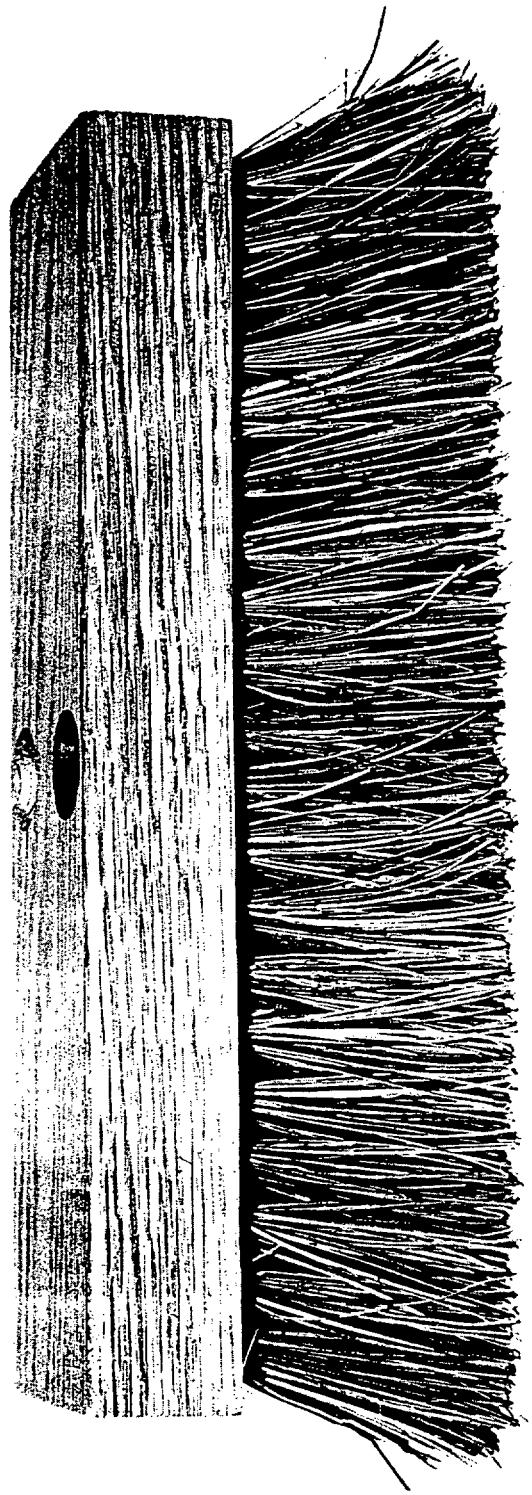


FIGURE 1.

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